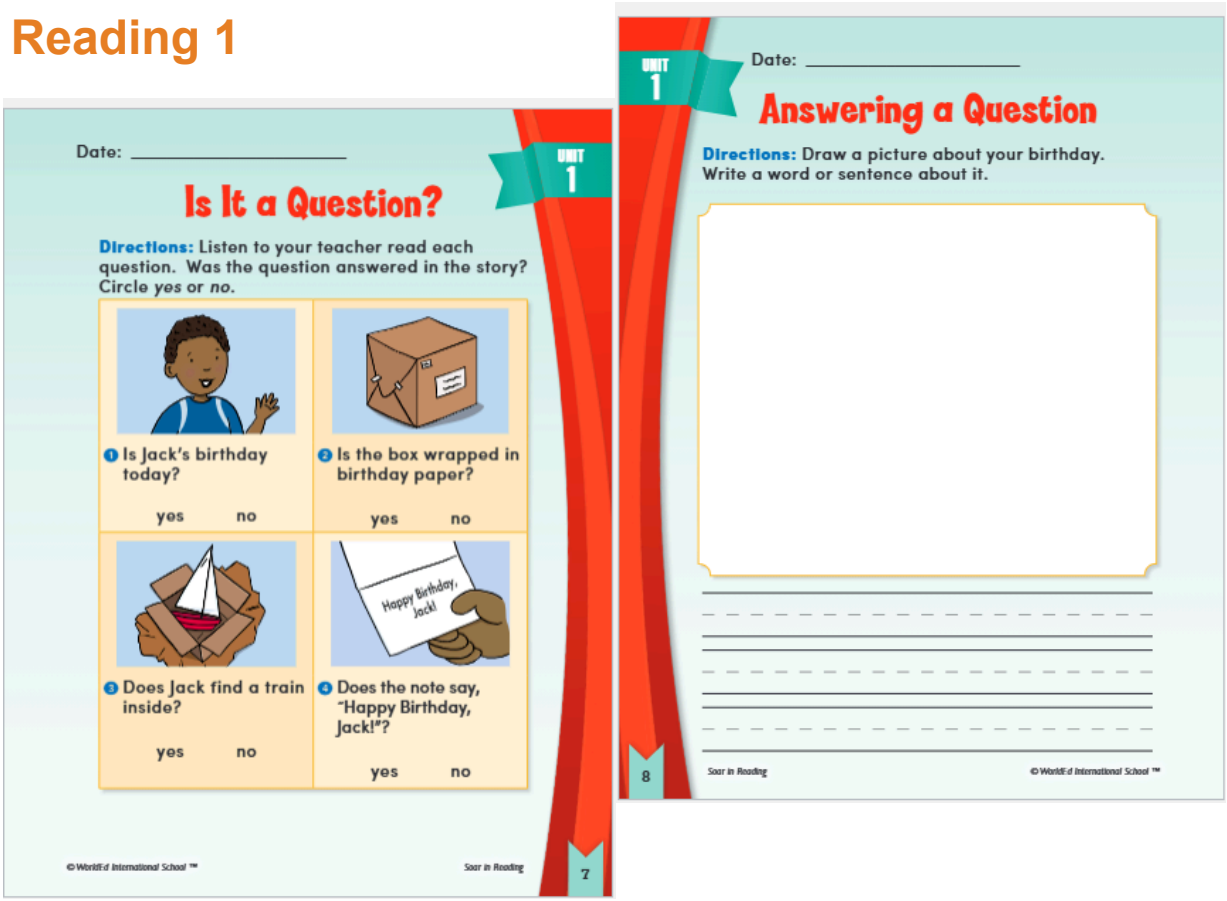
Lesson 3 - Jack´s Birthday | Connecting personal experiences to reading and developing writing skills through expressive activities.

Soar in Reading 1



Grade Level: 1

Duration: 40 minutes

Focus: Connecting personal experiences to reading and developing writing skills through expressive activities.

Subject: English Language Arts – Reading and Writing

Pages: Pages 7 and 8

Unit 1

Lesson Title: Personal Connections and Creative Writing: Exploring Birthdays

Standards Alignment

Relevant Standards:

- **ELA-LITERACY.W.1.3:** Write narratives in which students recount two or more appropriately sequenced events, include some details, and provide a sense of closure.
- **ELA-LITERACY.RL.1.1:** Ask and answer questions about key details in a text.
- **ELA-LITERACY.L.1.1.A:** Print all upper- and lowercase letters.

Lesson Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will:

- Make personal connections to the story by reflecting on their own birthday experiences.
- Practice fine motor skills by tracing and writing letters.
- Develop creative writing skills by describing a scene related to a birthday.

Materials Needed

For the Teacher:

- Projector or printed images of birthday scenes for inspiration
- Images of a cake, gifts, and friends to project during the hook
- Sample sentences and pictures for modeling the activity
- Markers or a whiteboard for demonstration

For the Students:

- Pencils
- Crayons or colored pencils
- Student workbooks open to Pages 7 and 8

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1. Presentation (5-10 minutes)

***Objective**: Introduce the concept of connecting personal experiences to reading and demonstrate writing and drawing tasks.*

Hook

A. Project images of a cake, gifts, and friends on the board.
B. Ask students, “What do you love about your birthday? Is it the cake, the gifts, or being with your friends?”
C. Write their answers on the board to create excitement.

Introduce the Concept

A. Explain: “Today, we will think about our birthdays and write and draw something special about them. Just like Jack had his big red boat, you can think of something that made your birthday special.”

Demonstrate:

A. Model drawing a simple picture of a birthday scene (e.g., a cake with candles or opening a gift).
B. Tell students what you love about your birthday.
C. Then, copy the sentences you previously wrote on the board during the hook: “I had a big chocolate cake for my birthday. I love chocolate cakes.”

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2. Warm-Up Activity (5–7 minutes)

***Objective:** Activate prior knowledge by sharing and discussing birthday memories.*

Activity Instructions:

A. Present three simple answers about a birthday party to the class:
   - “I love the birthday cake.”
   - “I love getting gifts.”
   - “I love playing with my friends.”

B. Write these answers on the board and ask students to repeat them aloud as a class.

C. Write the dialogue model on the board and roleplay so students understand how it has to be practiced.
   - Friend 1 asks: “What do you love about your birthday?”
   - Friend 2 answer: “I love getting gifts.”

D. Pair up students and have them practice the dialogue using the answers from the board. Give 2 minutes for each pair to practice.

E. Walk around to listen to their conversations and provide feedback.

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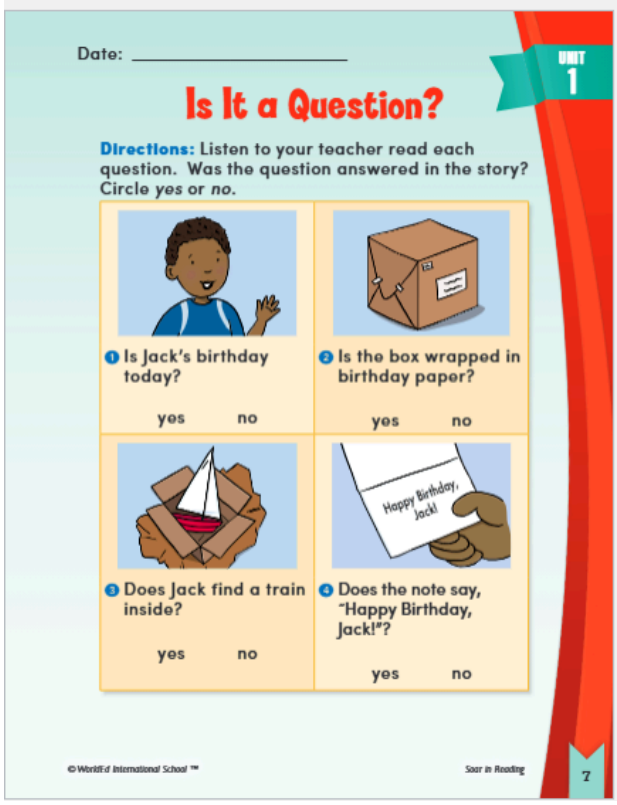
3. Practice (5-10 minutes)

Objective: *Guide students in understanding and responding to questions based on the story.*


Date: _____

UNIT 1

Is It a Question?

Directions: Listen to your teacher read each question. Was the question answered in the story? Circle *yes* or *no*.

1. Is Jack's birthday today? yes no
2. Is the box wrapped in birthday paper? yes no
3. Does Jack find a train inside? yes no
4. Does the note say, "Happy Birthday, Jack!"? yes no

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Instructions:

- Project Page 5 on the board again.
- Reread the story once more. While reading, ask the following questions and wait for students' responses. Then confirm the correct answer:

  “Is Jack’s birthday today?”

  “Is the box wrapped in birthday paper?”

  “Does Jack find a train inside?”

  “Does the note say, ‘Happy Birthday, Jack!’?”

- After rereading the story, ask students to open their books to Page 7. Tell them you will read the questions, and they need to circle 'yes' or 'no' based on their understanding. Model the first question as an example. Read and ask them to think and choose their answer.
- Upon completion, project on the board the correct answers.
- Circulate around the room to provide guidance, ensuring students comprehend the story and respond correctly.

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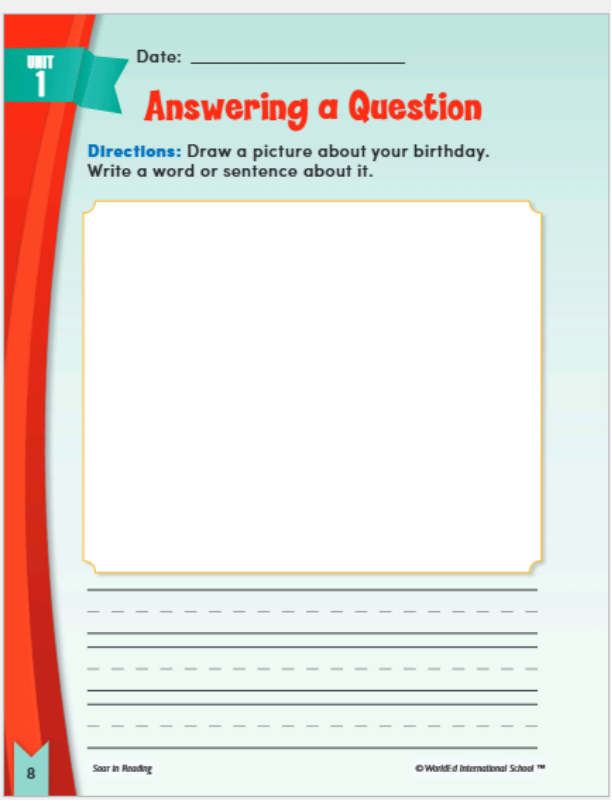
4. Production (10-15 minutes)

***Objective**: Allow students to independently demonstrate their writing and creative skills.*


UNIT 1

Date: _____

Answering a Question

Directions: Draw a picture about your birthday. Write a word or sentence about it.

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Instructions:

- Project Page 8 on the board.
- Ask students to turn their books to Page 8.
- Read the directions on Page 8 aloud. After reading the directions, ask students if they understand the task. Then explain that they will draw a picture about their birthday and write a word representing their drawing. They may copy words from the board or ask you for help if the word is not on the board.
- Provide additional support to students who may struggle with writing or forming sentences.

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5. Reading for Success Activity (10–15 minutes)

***Objective**: Reinforce the connection between personal experiences and story elements through a collaborative activity.*

Activity Instructions:

A. Create a paper class mural titled “Our Birthday Stories.”
B. Ask students to share their drawings and sentences from Pages 7 and 8.
C. Ask students to get their colored pencils and draw and write anything related to birthdays or about Jack’s birthday story.
D. Conclude by discussing similarities and differences in their birthday experiences, tying the activity back to Jack’s birthday in the story.

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6. Differentiation by Readiness

For Struggling Learners:

- Provide sentence starters such as “My birthday was…” or “I had…” to help them begin writing.
- Pair them with a supportive peer during the drawing and writing activities to build confidence.
- Offer additional practice by modeling how to trace and write letters.
- Read the questions aloud individually during the Practice activity and guide them step-by-step to find the correct answers in the text.

For Advanced Learners:

- Encourage them to write a detailed paragraph about their birthday, including at least three descriptive sentences.
- Challenge them to include creative details in their drawings, such as additional decorations or scenes from their birthday.
- Ask them to come up with their own questions related to the story of Jack’s birthday and discuss the answers with the class.
- Provide an opportunity for advanced learners to assist peers who need help during the activities, reinforcing their understanding by teaching others.

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7. Wrap-Up and Reflection (5-10 minutes)

- **Review Key Points:**

Ask students: “What makes birthdays special? What did you enjoy about drawing and writing today?”

Write some responses on the board.

- **Reflect:** Invite students to share one thing they learned or enjoyed during the lesson. Celebrate their efforts and creativity.

Why This Lesson Works

1. **Engagement:** The lesson uses personal experiences of students' birthday parties and creative tasks to keep students motivated and involved.
2. **Structure:** The progression from discussion to drawing and writing ensures that students are prepared for each task and have time to express themselves.
3. **Differentiation:** Tailored support and challenges ensure that all students can participate meaningfully, regardless of skill level.
4. **Relevance:** By connecting the lesson to real-life experiences, students find the activities relatable and meaningful, fostering a deeper connection to the material.